



SUSSURROS DO FOLCLORE

Game Design Document

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Universidade Anhembi Morumbi
São Paulo, 2026

Professional Portfolio Translation

This English version was created exclusively for professional portfolio presentation and international accessibility. The project, research, design process, development, and original academic documentation were conceived and produced in Portuguese. In case of any discrepancy, the original Portuguese version should be considered the authoritative document.

This generated PDF preserves the original document's reading order and image assets where they could be extracted from the source PDF. The Portuguese source remains the authoritative academic document.

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1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Project Identity Sussurros do Folclore is a Point and Click game developed at Unity, set in a rural Brazilian kitchen from the 1960s. The project investigates, in practice, the ability of environmental narrative and visual semiotics to communicate cultural elements of Brazilian folklore without resorting to text, dialogue or any form of direct verbal exposition. The game constitutes the validation executable of the Course Completion Work of the Universidade Anhembi Morumbi Game Design course.

1.2 Summary The player enters a rural kitchen in the interior of Minas Gerais and notices that something strange has happened. The Saci never appears directly: its presence is constructed exclusively by traces, out-of-place objects, changes in the environment and indexical visual signs. There is no HUD, text or narrator. The narrative emerges from the player's exploration and interpretation.

1.3 Target audience • Students and researchers of game design and interactive narrative. • Contemplative experience players: *Journey*, *What Remains of Edith Finch*, *Gone Home*. • Interested in Brazilian culture and folklore. • Academic and professional game design evaluators.

1.4 Platform and Scope Attribute Specification Platform PC (Windows) Engine Unity Genre Point and Click / Environmental Narrative Isometric Camera — diagonal top right Scope Academic prototype — single scenario Estimated duration 15 to 25 minutes per session Language No text — no need for verbal localization

2. CONCEPT AND NARRATIVE

2.1 Premise A kitchen rural was visited by Saci. Nobody saw him. Nobody heard him. But the tracks are everywhere. The player arrives after the event: his role is not to fight or follow instructions, but to observe, interpret and mentally reconstruct what happened. Narrative is non-linear, non-verbal and emergent.

2.2 Cultural Context Saci-Pererê is one of the richest figures in Brazilian folklore. As documented by Luís from Câmara Cascudo (2012), Saci results from the convergence of indigenous, African and European traditions, with an ambiguous character: mischievous, unpredictable, linked to rural space and 3

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domestic. Renato Queiroz (2001) and Andriolli Costa (2020) deepen his reading as the trickster archetype, which manifests itself through effects in the environment, never through direct appearances.

2.3 Space as a Narrative Henry Jenkins (2004) proposes that games should be understood as narrative architectures: spaces that distribute narrative potential throughout their layout, objects and visual composition. Every detail in the kitchen operates as an indexical sign in the Peircean sense — it points to the existence of a past action. The player, by interpreting these signs, reconstructs the narrative without it needing to be told.

2.4 Narrative Structure • Layer 1 - The inhabited space: the kitchen as a place of everyday life, with its marks of use and material culture. • Layer 2 - The intervention: the traces of Saci superimposed on everyday life. • Layer 3 - Folklore: identification of traditional signs of myth.

3. GAMEPLAY AND MECHANICS

3.1 Main Loop Stage Description Explore The player moves freely around the scene, discovering the space. Observe When approaching objects, details are revealed.

Interblack The player establishes relationships between the signs and builds hypotheses. **Interagir** Objects respond to interaction by revealing new information. **Discover** The narrative emerges as the signs are connected.

3.2 Mechanics Point and Click movement with fixed isometric camera. Slow, contemplative pace — no running, jumping or stamina. **Interaction with Objects** Contextual cursor indicates available interaction. The player can examine, pick up (visual inventory without text) and place objects, activating environmental responses. **Environmental Reading** When the player connects related objects, subtle environmental events are activated: sounds, movements, lighting changes. No event explains the narrative, they all reinforce the feeling of presence.

3.3 Controls The controls were designed to keep the experience simple and accessible, allowing the player to focus their attention on exploring the scenario and interpreting environmental cues and paying more attention to the environment. 4

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Command Action Left mouse click Move the character around the scene. Right mouse click As you get closer to objects, details are revealed. E key Interact with the lamp. Movement by left click follows the project's Point and Click proposal. The right click is used in actions related to objects, allowing the player to collect and reposition them while solving puzzles. The E key was reserved for interacting with the lamp, which acts as a functional element for lighting and exploring the environment.

3.4 Lack of HUD and Text The game does not have a textual interface of any kind. This absence is structural and methodological, for the TCC hypothesis to be tested, all communication must occur exclusively through visual and auditory signs.

4. GAME WORLD

4.1 The Setting: The Rural Kitchen The only setting is a rural kitchen in the interior of Minas Gerais, in the 1960s, measuring approximately 8m x 6m. **Mandatory elements:** wood stove, central table, shelves with utensils, rustic cabinet, wooden bench, wide plank floor, window with simple curtain and hanging utensils.

4.2 Exploration Flow Point Element Function Narrative 1 Gateway First contact with the disturbed environment. 2 Central table Visual hub — displaced objects draw immediate attention. 3 Wood burning stove Recent ashes and pipe suggest recent presence. 4 Shelves Utensils out of place and knots in fabrics. 5 Red hood locker and catch bottle. 6 Window Footprints on the sill, dust devil, outside light.

4.3 Narrative Props Sign Prop Narrative Reading Red hood Icon + Index Identifiable presence of the Saci — object outside of everyday domestic life. Hot pipe Temporality index Still burning — the Saci was here a while ago. One-legged footprints Index of movement Unequivocal trace of the folk figure. Dust devil Displacement index Physical manifestation of Saci passage. Sieve and bottle Folk symbols Capture objects — activate the cultural repertoire. 5

Bank toppled Index of sudden action Evidence of mischief — physical intervention in space. Knots in Fabric Mischief Index Folk practice attributed to Saci. Recent Ashes Recent Usage Index The stove has been moved—something has been here.

5. PUZZLES AND INTERPRETATION CHALLENGES

5.1 Philosophy Puzzles are not mechanical obstacles: they are invitations to interpretation. None of them have a wrong solution in the traditional sense, the challenge is to read and connect signs. According to Chang (2011), the player acts as an interpreter of an environmental text.

5.2 Puzzle 1 — Reconstruction of the Path The player connects footprints, ashes and displaced objects to reconstruct the Saci's path. When observing the elements in sequence, a subtle visual trail reveals itself on the floor. Each footprint operates as an indexical sign of secondness (PEIRCE, 2005).

5.3 Puzzle 2 — Sequence of Events By placing the collected objects in narratively correct positions, micro-events are activated: the ember lights up, the whirlpool spins, a shadow passes through the window. The embedded narrative (JENKINS, 2004) was inscribed in the space from the beginning.

5.4 Puzzle 3 — Symbolic Capture Bringing together the sieve, bottle and whirlpool in the correct spatial relationship triggers an ambiguous visual event: the bottle shakes briefly. The tradition is documented by Cascudo (2012). The event neither confirms nor denies the capture, it preserves the trickster's ambiguity.

5.5 Puzzle 4 — Space Reading After exploring all the elements, the player who remains standing in the center of the scene triggers the closure: the music rises gently, the wind enters through the window. No victory screen, no text, no narration

6. PLAYABLE CHARACTER Young explorer, informal researcher of Brazilian folklore. Function exclusively as a vehicle for exploration, it does not speak, does not comment. Stylized cartoon style inspired by Gravity Falls, chibi Tintin and Hunters from Saci RPG. Element Color Field hat — wide brim Brown leather #6A4A2B Plain shirt — mustard Burnt mustard #C38B2A Work pants Petroleum blue #355C6F Leather backpack Dark brown #4D2E1A

7. ART DIRECTION Stylized cartoon with semi-realistic influences. Clear narrative readability without photographic realism or caricature. Layer Function Colors 6

Main Points of interest — attracts the eye Rust #8C3B1E | Ocher #C4974A | Brown #4D2E1A Secondary Environmental Fill Moss Green #556B3C | Petroleum blue #2F4F5A | Beige #C8B89A Main font: IM Fell English (titles and visual identity). Secondary source: Cormorant Garamond (subtitles and academic materials).

8. AUDIO DESIGN The audio operates as a narrative layer: country guitar, bamboo flute and subtle percussion. Wind is the main auditory index of the Saci, intensity and direction vary depending on exploration. No speaking, narration or dubbing. Library of selected effects For the prototype, the sounds Wind, Intense wind, Whirlwind, Fire and firewood, Footsteps in the house, Squeaking house, Squeaking house 2, Squeaking house 3, Ambient sound, Picking up bottle, Rattle and Hollow wood were selected. The set covers the ambiance of the kitchen, the character's movement, interaction with objects and, mainly, the sound presence of the Saci. The wind and the whirlwind function as narrative indices; the fire, the creaks and the wood reinforce the materiality of the space; footsteps and object sounds provide feedback to the player's actions.

Fig. 8.1: Initial library of sound effects selected for the prototype. Source: team collection (2026). Credits and usage permissions The sound effects used were obtained from content available on Pixabay. To record the origin of the materials and facilitate consultation of the platform's conditions of use, the profiles of the authors used in the prototype were included below. • SoundReality: <https://pixabay.com/users/soundreality-31074404/> • Freesound Community: https://pixabay.com/users/freesound_community-46691455/ • AlexZavesa: <https://pixabay.com/users/alexzavesa-24262182/> • Sumaga123: <https://pixabay.com/users/sumaga123-41603745/> • Dragon Studio: <https://pixabay.com/users/dragon-studio-38165424/>

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 chocalho	09/06/2026 17:32	Som no Formato ...	240 KB
 Vento intenso	09/06/2026 17:08	Som no Formato ...	585 KB
 Som ambiente	09/06/2026 16:57	Som no Formato ...	173 KB
 Casa rangendo 3	09/06/2026 16:56	Som no Formato ...	3.689 KB
 Pegando garrafa	09/06/2026 16:55	Som no Formato ...	102 KB
 Casa rangendo 2	09/06/2026 16:55	Som no Formato ...	104 KB
 Casa rangendo	09/06/2026 16:55	Som no Formato ...	48 KB
 Passos na casa	09/06/2026 16:50	Som no Formato ...	468 KB
 Fogo e lenha	09/06/2026 16:49	Som no Formato ...	573 KB
 Redemoinho	09/06/2026 16:48	Som no Formato ...	1.054 KB
 Vento	09/06/2026 16:46	Som no Formato ...	1.336 KB

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1. INTERFACE, TECHNICAL AND SCHEDULE InterMinimal face: contextual cursor and visual inventory without text. Engine Unity with URP. Repository: github.com/AmayoriRPG/TCC. Final delivery: June

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6. A. VISUAL

REFERENCES This section brings together the visual and design references that guided the design decisions, art direction and environmental narrative of the project.

A.1 Journey (2012) — thatgamecompany More direct reference to the narrative approach. Journey builds your entire experience without text or dialogue, communicating story through visual composition and spatial progression. It demonstrates how indexical signs distributed in space construct a dense narrative without any words. Fig.

A.1 — Journey: lighting as a guide. Fig.

A.2 — Journey: spatial progression. Fig.

A.3 — Journey: visual composition.

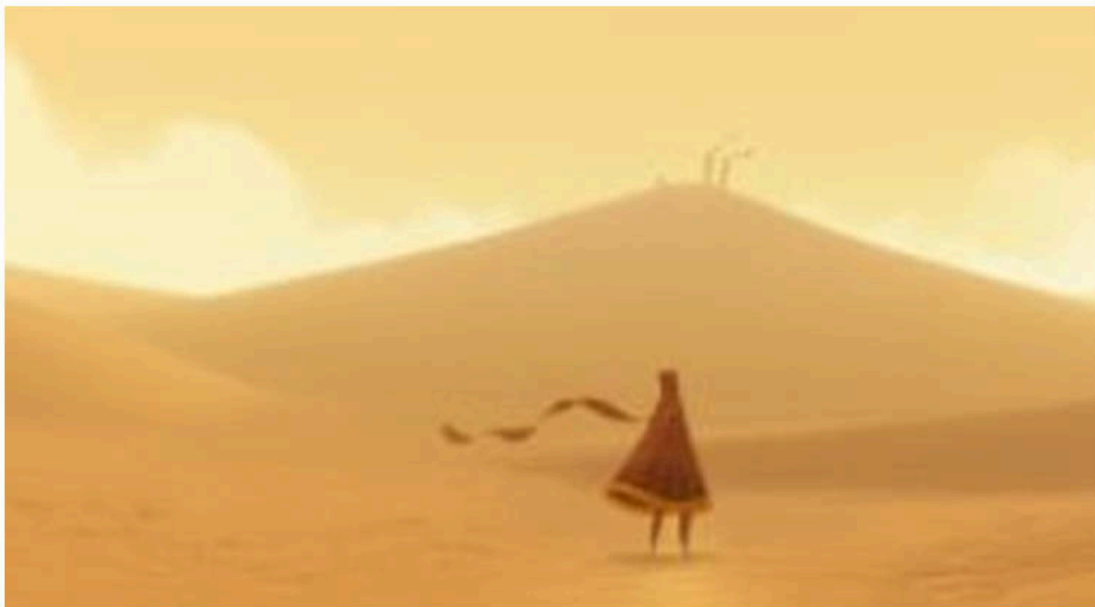
A.2 Character References — The Explorer The character was built on the archetype of the curious adventurer. References include Gravity Falls, Tintin, chibi Indiana Jones and Saci RPG Hunters protagonists. Fig.

A.4 — Visual references of the explorer character. Source: team collection (2026).

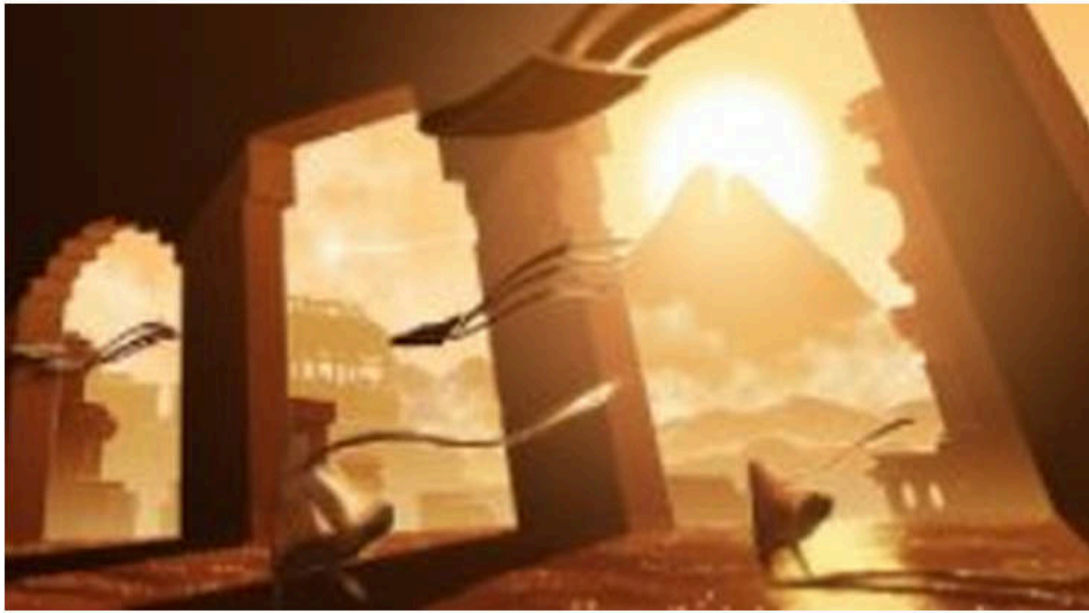
A.3 Dark Souls (2011) — FromSoftware Core reference for fragmented storytelling. In Dark Souls the history is inferred at 8



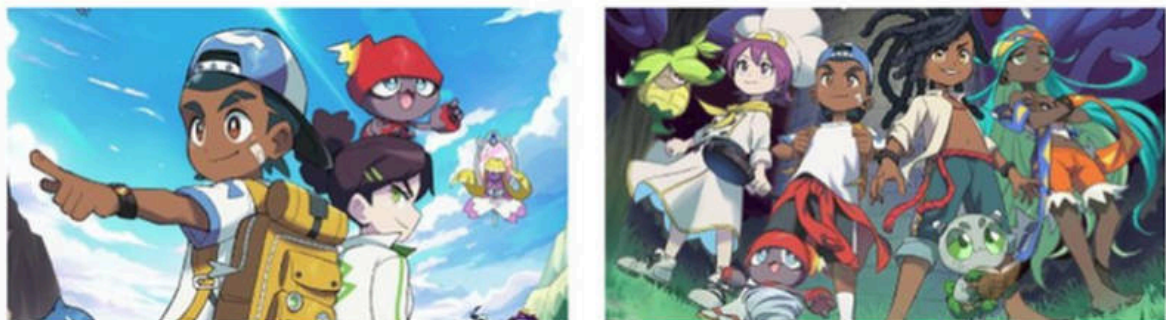
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starting from the state of the objects and the organization of the space, a direct model for the narrative props of the kitchen. Fig.

A.5 — Dark Souls: architecture as a trace. Fig.

A.6 — Dark Souls: enlightenment and discovery. Fig.

A.7 — Dark Souls: investigative stance. Fig.

A.8 — Dark Souls: ruins as language.

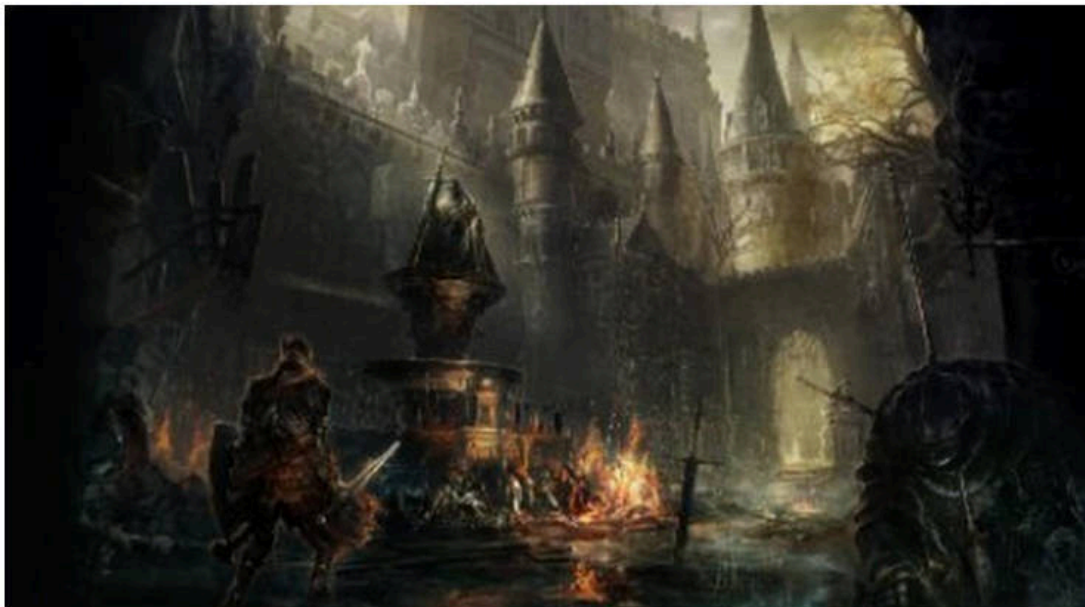
A.4 Grim Fandango (1998) — LucasArts Demonstrates how to build cultural identity in play through architecture, costumes and objects without having to explain the culture. Mexican folklore is structurally incorporated, a model for the representation of Brazilian folklore in Sussurros do Folclore. Fig.

A.9 — Grim Fandango: cultural identity. Fig.

A.10 — Grim Fandango: symbolic folklore. Fig.

A.11 — Grim Fandango: art direction.

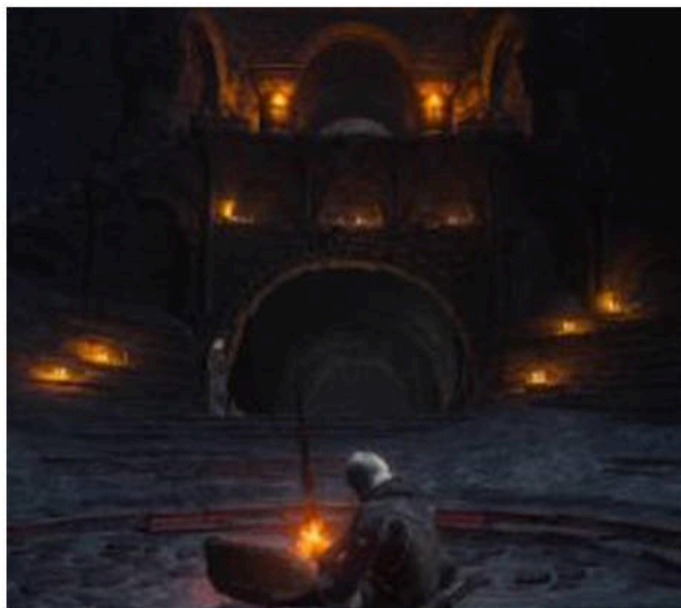
A.5 What Remains of Edith Finch (2017) Demonstrates that a single home environment can support dense narrative experience. Objects are not decoration: they are carriers of meaning. The Sussurros do Folclore kitchen applies the same principle. 9



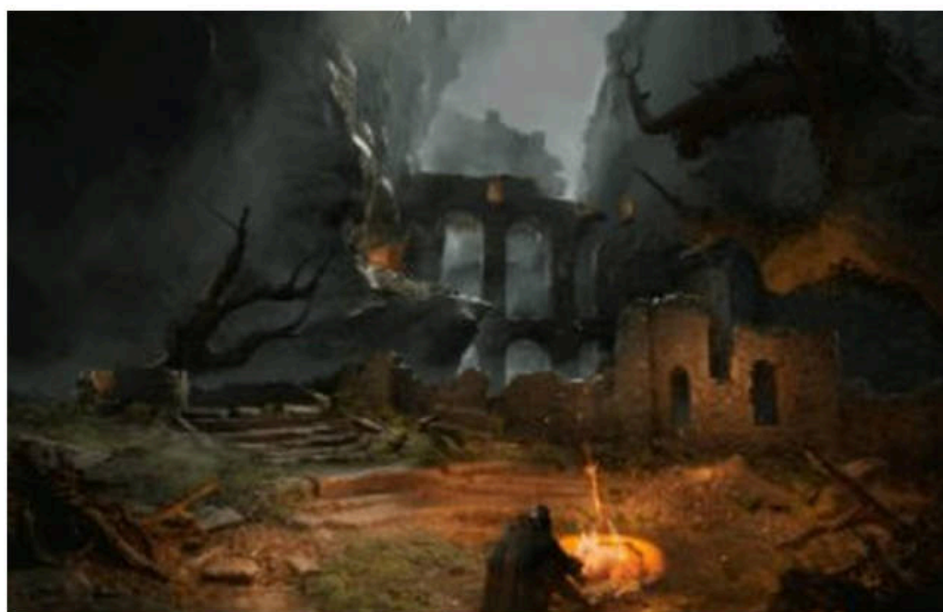
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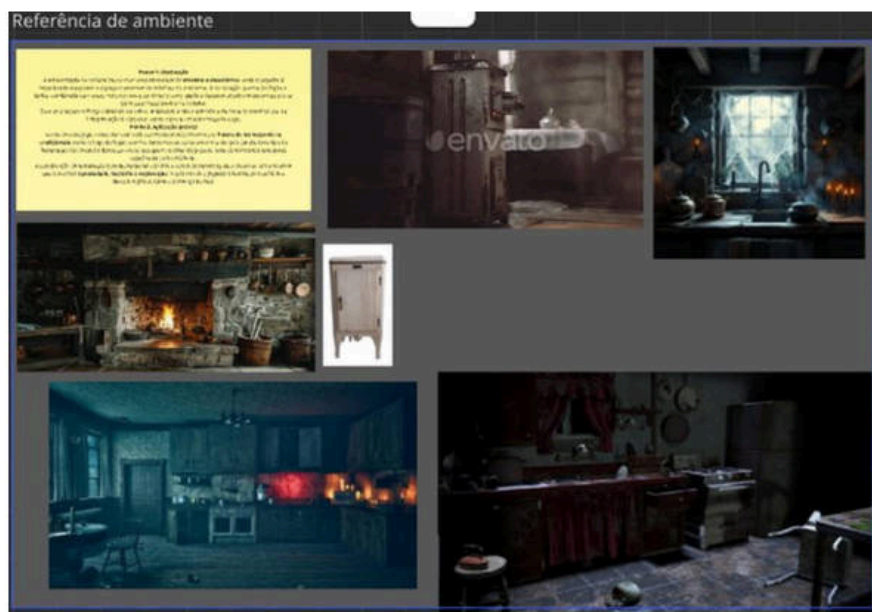
Fig.

A.12 — Edith Finch: objects as memory. Fig.

A.13 — Edith Finch: environment as structure.

A.6 Environment References — The Rural Kitchen The environment seeks to create an atmosphere of mystery and discovery, where the player is encouraged to explore and observe the details. Warm lighting from the wood stove, combined with darker areas and soft shadows, highlights important objects and creates visual contrast within the kitchen. In the game's setting, the kitchen is lit mainly by natural or traditional light sources: the fire from the wood stove, lanterns or soft light coming through the window. This type of lighting creates areas of visual highlight that guide the player's gaze to the narrative elements spread throughout the environment. Fig.

A.6 — Moodboard of environmental references: historic rural kitchens and lighting.
Source: team collection (2026). 10



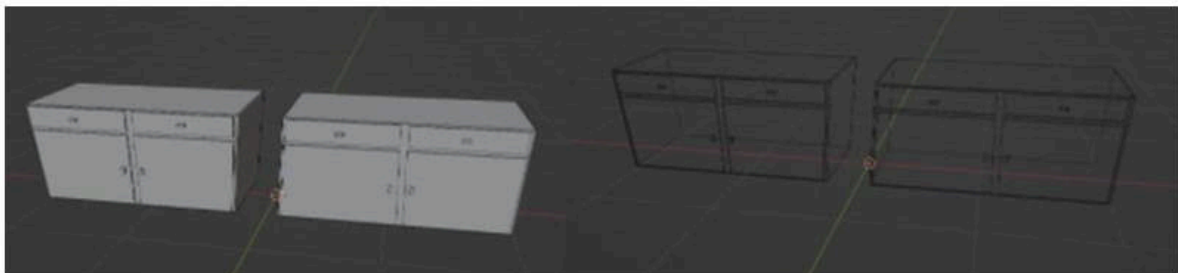
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B. DEVELOPMENT TEAM Member Area Tools Alexandre Tan Vitor 3D Modeling Blender, Substance Painter, Unity Adriano Oliveira Azevedo 3D Modeling, Animation and Painting Blender, Substance Painter, Unity Victor Miguel Morales Lopes Programming Unity (C#) Tamir Borges Lins dos Santos UI / Interface Figma Reinhold Gustav Berner Pre-production, Documentation, Pitch and TCC Docs, Word, Miro, Canva, DaVinci Resolve C. DEVELOPMENT PROCESS This section documents the production process through visual records of each development front.

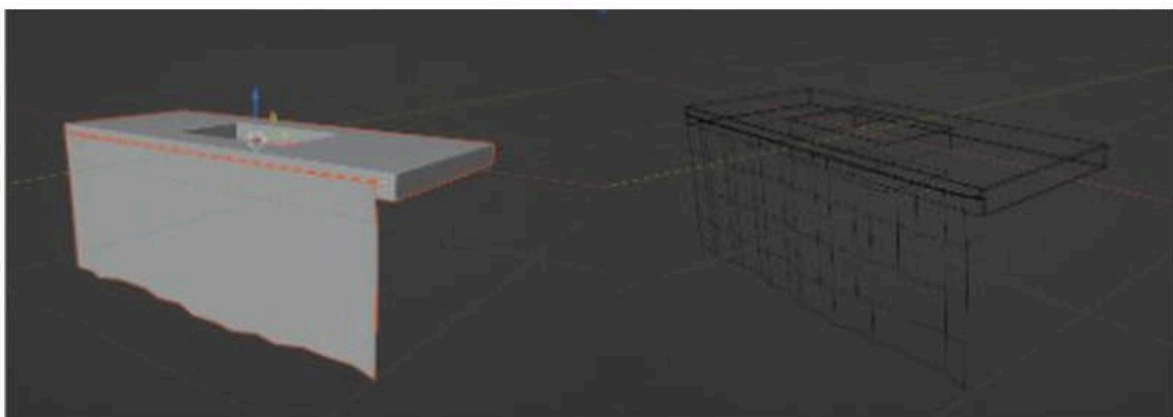
C.1 3D Modeling — Blender Asset modeling was developed in Blender, covering narrative props, kitchen furniture and the playable character. The process involved polygonal modeling and UV mapping preparatory to texturing. Fig.

C.1 — Modeling of the counter/cabinet: solid and wireframe. Blender. Source: team collection (2026). Fig.

C.2 — Table/bench modeling: solid and wireframe. Blender. Source: team collection (2026). 11



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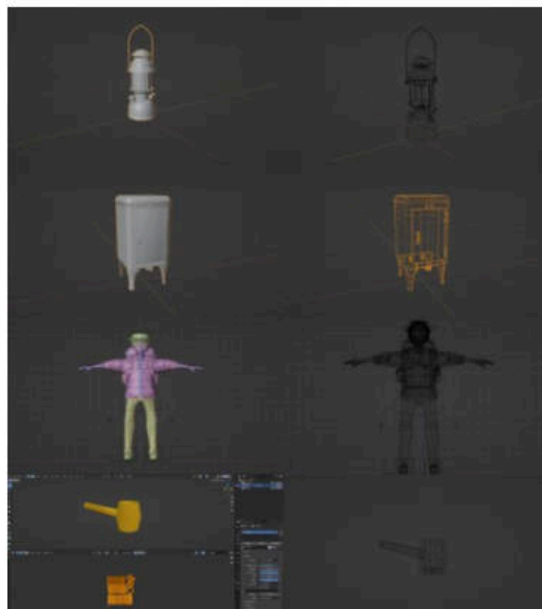
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Fig.

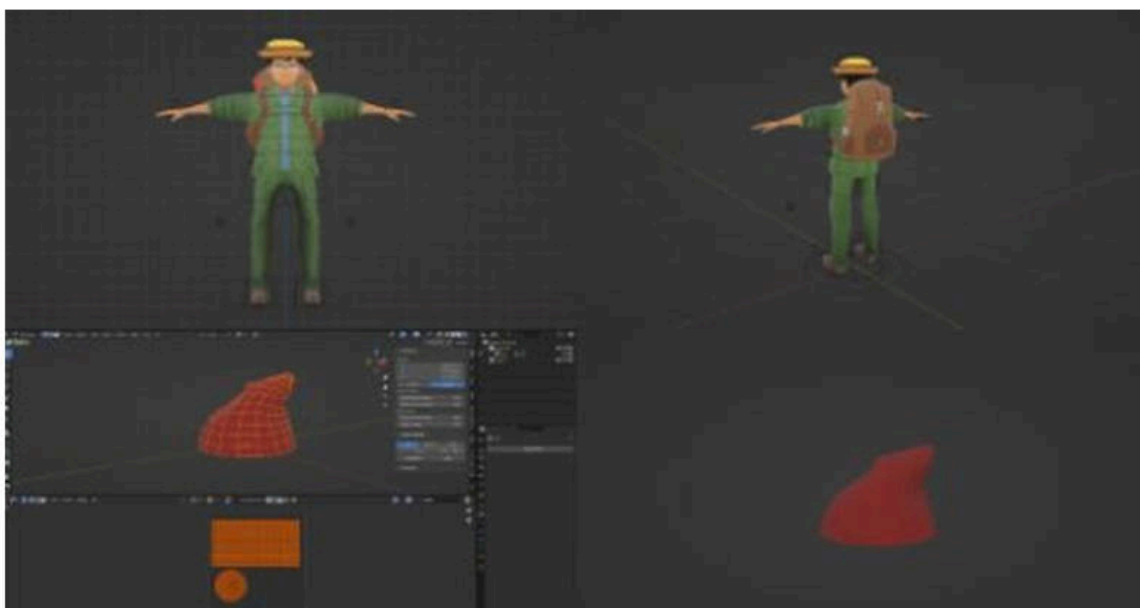
C.3 — Assorted props: lantern, cabinet, base character and pipe. Blender. Source: team collection (2026).

C.2 Character Modeling and Painting The character was modeled in Blender in T-pose and painted in Substance Painter, focusing on legibility within the isometric scenario. Fig.

C.4 — Character in T-pose and detail of the hood. Blender. Source: team collection (2026). 12



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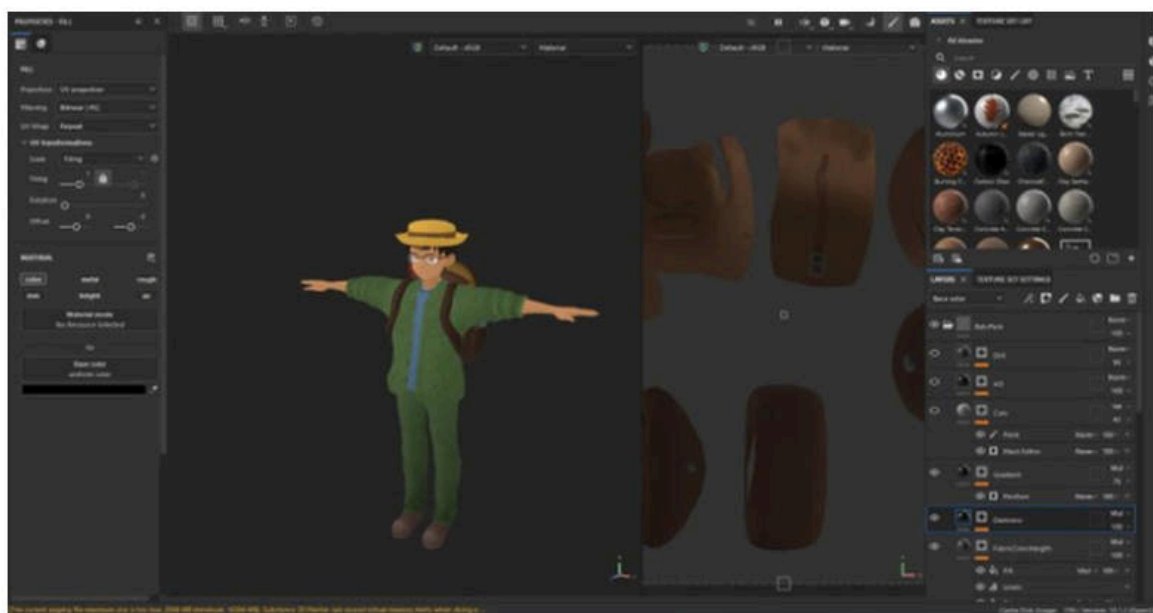
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Fig.

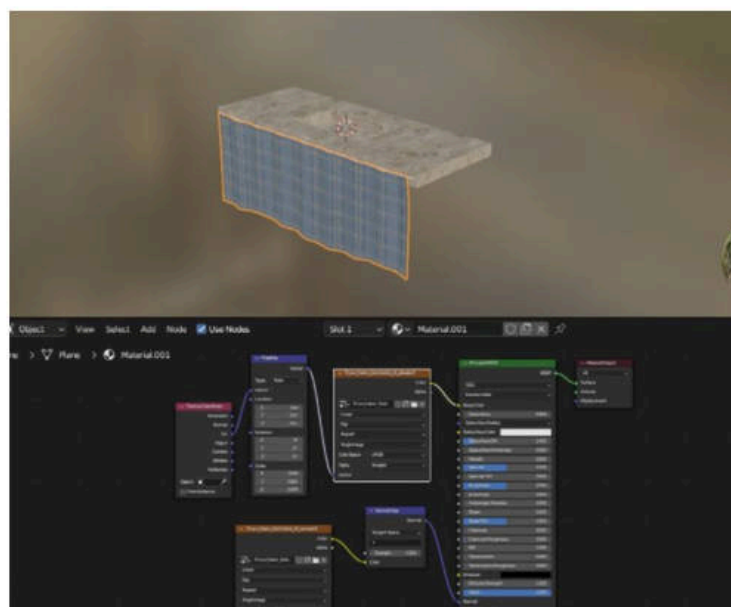
C.5 — Painting character textures in Substance Painter. Source: team collection (2026).

C.3 Texturing and Materials Texturing in Substance Painter for the character and main props, and node system in Blender for procedural scene materials. Fig.

C.6 — Node graph with texture applied to the table. Blender. Source: team collection (2026). 13



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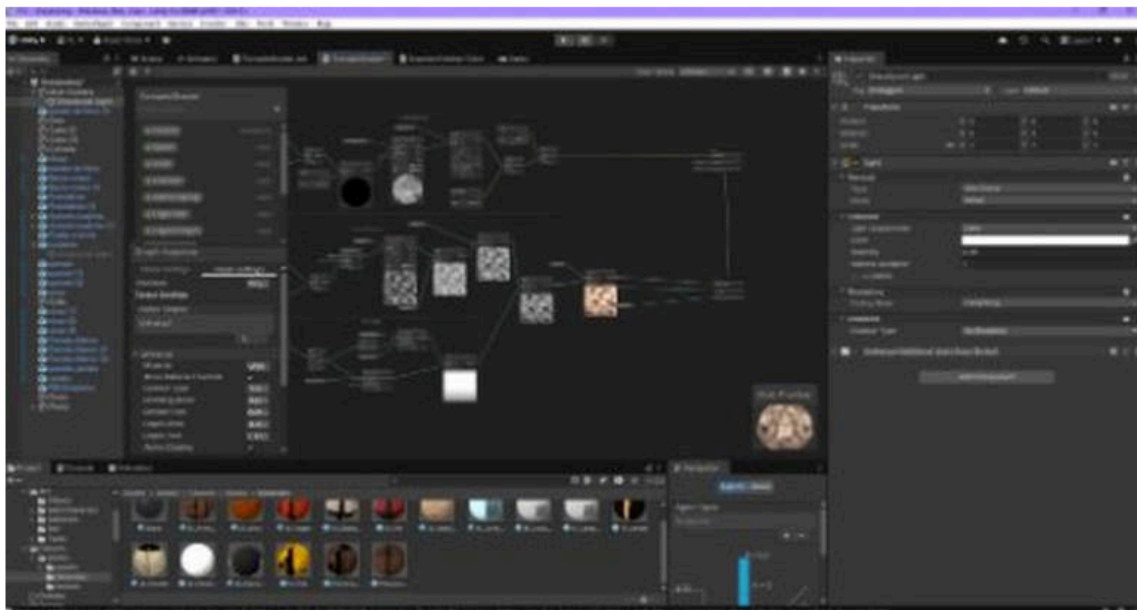
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Fig.

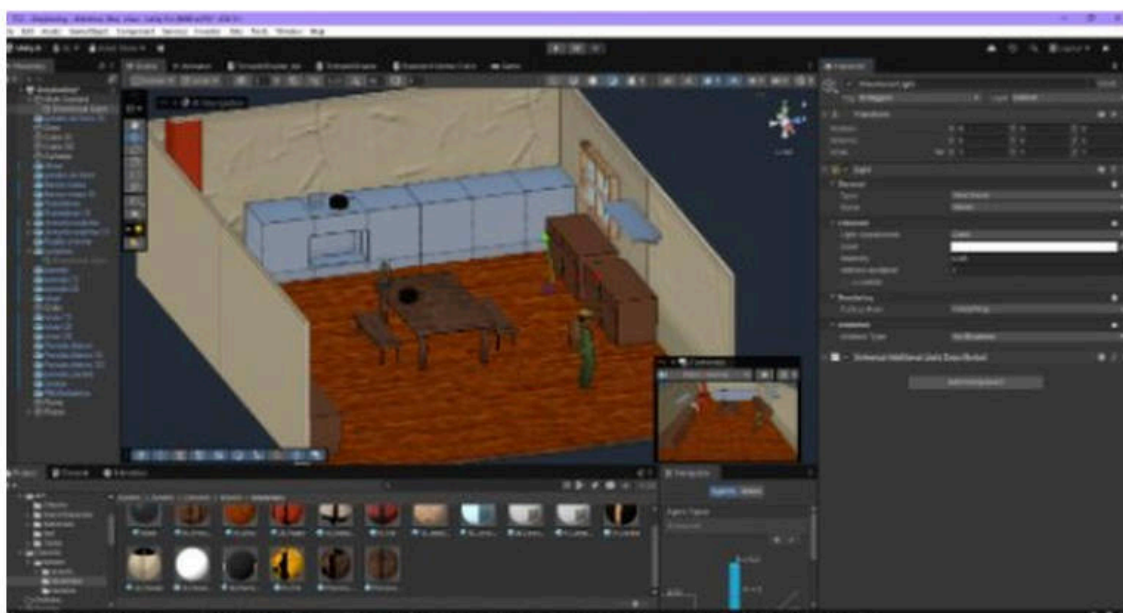
C.7 — Material node graph in Unity. Source: team collection (2026).

C.4 Scene in the Unity — Isometric Camera Integration of assets in the Unity: isometric scene, diagonal camera, warm stove lighting and distribution of narrative props according to the level design. Fig.

C.8 — Complete isometric scene of the kitchen in Unity. Source: team collection (2026). 14



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Fig.

C.9 — Narrative props (bottle, hood, pipe) integrated into the scene. Source: team collection (2026).

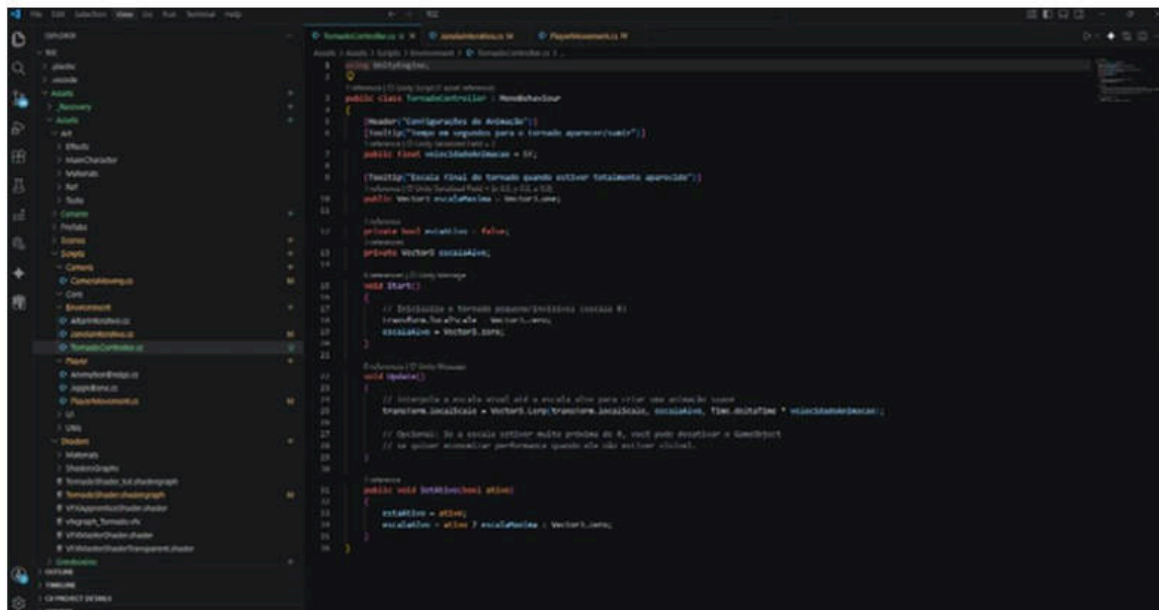
C.5 Programming — Unity and C# TornadoController script, responsible for the animated behavior of the whirlpool, the main visual and auditory index of the Saci. Interscales the effect for smooth animation without cutscenes or text. Fig.

C.10 — TornadoController.cs: whirlpool control on Unity. Source: team collection (2026).

C.6 Design of Interface — Figma UI developed on Figma: contextual cursor, visual inventory without text, menus and visual identity. Includes palette studies and UI comparisons of Brazilian folklore games. 15



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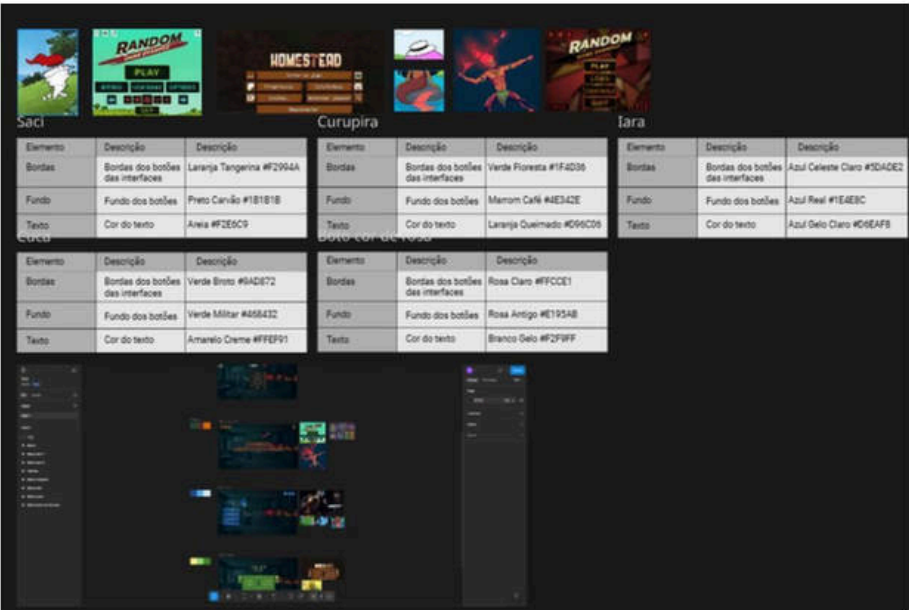
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Fig.

C.11 — UI no Figma: paletas, referências de personagens e protótipos de tela. Fonte: acervo da equipe (2026). Expansão conceitual dos menus Além da interface desenvolvida para o protótipo, o projeto foi pensado com possibilidade de expansão em fases futuras, cada uma dedicada a uma figura diferente do folclore brasileiro. Para representar essa continuidade, foram criadas variações conceituais de menu para o Saci, o Curupira, a Iara, o Boto e a Cuca. A proposta é que cada fase tenha um menu próprio, com mudanças de cor, símbolo e composição visual que antecipem qual mito o protagonista irá investigar e caçar. Os estudos mantêm uma estrutura visual comum para preservar a identidade do projeto, enquanto alteram a paleta, o ícone e a distribuição dos elementos para diferenciar cada mito. Assim, a tela inicial também funciona como uma introdução visual ao personagem folclórico e ao clima da fase antes do início da exploração. Fig. C.12: Menu conceitual da fase do Saci. Fonte: acervo da equipe (2026). Fig. C.13: Menu conceitual da fase do Curupira. Fonte: acervo da equipe (2026). 16



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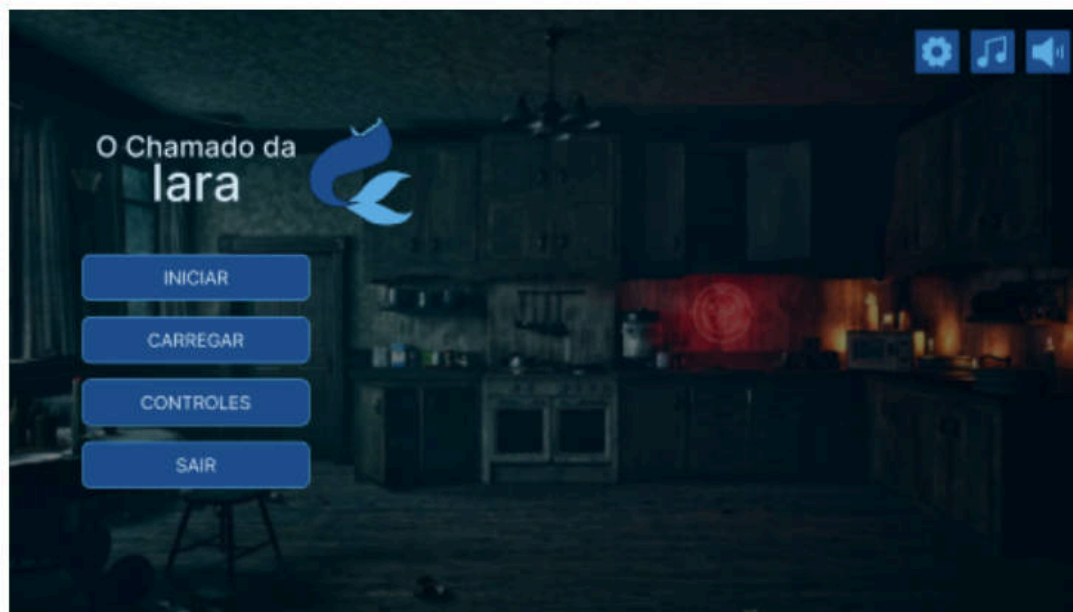
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Fig. C.14: Menu conceitual da fase da Iara. Fonte: acervo da equipe (2026). Fig. C.15: Menu conceitual da fase do Boto. Fonte: acervo da equipe (2026). Fig. C.16: Menu conceitual da fase da Cuca. Fonte: acervo da equipe (2026). D. DOCUMENTOS, LINKS E ASSETS EXTERNOS Esta seção reúne os principais documentos, plataformas e materiais externos utilizados na produção, documentação e apresentação de Sussurros do Folclore.

D.1 Documentos e Plataformas do Projeto Escrita do TCC: acessar documento em pdf ou Docx Página do projeto no itch.io: acessar página Figma do projeto: acessar arquivo Miro do projeto: acessar board Temática inicial do projeto: acessar documento Repositório do projeto no GitHub: acessar repositório Pitch do projeto: acessar o pitch

D.2 Assets Externos Durante a produção do cenário, foram utilizados props externos provenientes da Unity Asset Store. O material é identificado abaixo para registrar sua origem e autoria. Medieval Props Autor: Lukas Bobor Origem: Unity Asset Store Aplicação no projeto: props externos utilizados na composição do cenário. Página do pacote: acessar Medieval Props na Unity Asset Store 17



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